over the course of the film and ultimately leads to the inherent conflict of the film."

To bring this epic saga to the screen, Joe and Anthony Russo, who directed Marvel's ***Captain America: The Winter Soldier,*** returned to helm the continuation of Steve Rogers' story. The pair knew ***Civil War*** would be a perfect choice to continue crafting a grounded, super-hero thriller while balancing an intricate character story. "The concept of ***Civil War*** is very important," Joe Russo says. "We felt like we needed to go in a radical direction if we were going to do another ***Captain America.*** So we were strongly advocating for the ***Civil War*** storyline. Once everyone agreed to it, we sat and carefully broke out the arcs of each character, figured out what we wanted the movie to be, and spent probably close to a year in a room with the writers working on the script."

"Captain America is the leader of the Avengers, and part of that job is holding this growing and disparate group of people together," Anthony Russo explains. "It becomes harder and harder as you move forward, and at some point that is going to come to a tipping point—and that is here in this movie. So that is really, I think, the interesting thing of what happens to Steve Rogers here—sort of 'What happens when it all falls apart?'"

"You've never seen this kind of emotional disarray amongst this group of characters," Joe Russo continues. "You've never seen the stakes this high, because they're personal now. The stakes are driving the characters in a way you've never seen on camera, or in the Marvel Cinematic Universe at this point. It leads to a very difficult and uncomfortable place, so it's what sets it apart from any of the other films up to this point. There is both a physical scale and an emotional scale that I think people haven't seen before."

The fulcrum of this emotional scale extends beyond Steve and Tony's disagreement about the Sokovia Accords. The film also finds Bucky Barnes, a.k.a. the Winter Soldier, in the center of the conflict. Although he was brainwashed and forced into performing the unspeakable acts of assassination hinted at in ***The Winter Soldier,*** Steve continues to pursue Bucky with a hopeful heart. "I think the strength is the personal story of friendship between Steve Rogers and Bucky Barnes," Executive Producer Nate Moore says. "So as much as ***Civil War*** is the trappings of the film, it's really about Steve



Art from *Civil War #1* by Steve McNiven, Dexter Vines, and Morry Hollowell.